

Untitled Lead Magnet

A practical checklist of 5 free tools to streamline your social media, save time, and grow your brand without a big budget

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CHAPTER 1

' Tool #1: Canva — Visual Content Creation

- [] Create a free Canva account at canva.com
- [] Set up your Brand Kit (logo, brand colors, fonts)
- [] Browse social media templates sized for each platform (Instagram, Facebook, LinkedIn)
- [] Design at least 5 reusable post templates
- [] Save designs to a dedicated Brand Folder for quick access
- [] Use the Content Planner to schedule posts directly from Canva

> Pro Tip: Create a set of 3–5 templates per post type (quote, tip, promotion) to maintain consistency and cut design time in half.

CHAPTER 2

' Tool #2: Buffer — Social Media Scheduling

- [] Sign up for a free Buffer account at buffer.com
- [] Connect up to 3 social media profiles (free plan)
- [] Set your optimal posting schedule for each platform
- [] Batch-create and queue 1–2 weeks of posts at a time
- [] Use the link shortener for trackable URLs
- [] Review the Analytics tab weekly to see top-performing posts

> Pro Tip: Schedule posts during your audience's peak hours — check each platform's native insights first to find the best times.

CHAPTER 3

' Tool #3: Google Trends & AnswerThePublic — Content Ideas

- [] Visit trends.google.com and search your niche keywords
- [] Filter by country and timeframe (past 90 days) to find trending topics
- [] Note seasonal spikes and plan content around them
- [] Go to answerthepublic.com and enter your main keyword
- [] Export the question map as a CSV or image
- [] Pick 5–10 questions to turn into posts, reels, or stories
- [] Build a running Content Idea Bank (Google Sheet or Notion)

> Pro Tip: Use AnswerThePublic questions as caption hooks — "Ever wondered why...?" posts drive high engagement.

CHAPTER 4

' Tool #4: Meta Business Suite — Free Analytics & Posting

- [] Set up Meta Business Suite at business.facebook.com
- [] Connect your Facebook Page and Instagram account
- [] Review the Insights dashboard: reach, engagement, follower growth
- [] Check your audience demographics (age, location, active hours)
- [] Use the built-in Planner to schedule Facebook and Instagram posts for free
- [] Monitor comments and DMs from one unified inbox
- [] Set up at least one saved reply for common customer questions

> Pro Tip: Cross-post strategically — not every post works on both platforms. Check which format (Reels vs. static) performs best per channel.

CHAPTER 5

' Tool #5: ChatGPT (Free Tier) — Caption & Copy Writing

- [] Create a free account at chat.openai.com
- [] Write a brand prompt template including: tone, audience, niche, and CTA style
- [] Use it to generate 5–10 caption variations per post — then pick the best
- [] Generate hashtag sets for each content category
- [] Draft bio copy, story scripts, and content calendars
- [] Ask it to repurpose one piece of content into 3 different formats
- [] Save your best prompts in a Prompt Library doc for reuse

> Pro Tip: Always edit AI output to match your authentic voice before posting. Use it as a starting point, not a final draft.

🚀 Quick-Start Action Plan

| Priority | Action | Time Needed |

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| 1 | Set up Canva Brand Kit | 30 min |

| 2 | Connect Buffer & schedule first week | 1 hour |

| 3 | Generate 20 content ideas with AnswerThePublic | 30 min |

| 4 | Link Instagram to Meta Business Suite | 15 min |

| 5 | Write your ChatGPT brand prompt template | 20 min |

Total setup time: ~2.5 hours. Then maintain weekly in under 3 hours.